

Aksharaa Bhobe

Consumer Insights and Strategy

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CONSULTING & CLIENT RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Product & Brand Strategy Consultant

June 2026 – August 2026

SWISSGEAR × Group III International | Client engagement under NDA

- Scored six whitespace categories on a weighted scorecard; sized the top opportunity within a \$6.22B category (TAM/SAM/SOM, anchored to client order and AOV data) at a ~\$36M Year-5 obtainable market.
- Fielded three surveys (~2,400 respondents) with an attitudinal battery to define right-to-play and right-to-win spaces.
- Ran k-means segmentation and factor analysis in R to identify four buyer segments and the highest-potential growth segment.
- Surfaced unmet needs through pain-point ranking; validated demand with willingness-to-pay and intent models.
- Built 1/3/5-year SOM projections and a go-to-market recommendation; scope expanded to independently developing the winning category's product brief. Led client communication under NDA, including limits on AI tool use.

Senior Research Associate

April 2024 – July 2025

Third Eye Integrated Services, Mumbai | Supplier-side research and brand consultancy; clients across tech, CPG, beauty, and finance

- Led end-to-end delivery of 20+ client studies annually, owning scope, budget, and quality; authored approach notes and proposals that turned ambiguous briefs into study designs; mentored a junior associate and interns.
- Developed a projective exercise for Mondelez that surfaced a key consumer tension, shifting the client's Valentine's Day campaign strategy from grand gestures to small, relatable moments.
- Ran ethnographic immersions, depth interviews, and longitudinal digital diaries; recruited and facilitated expert-interview sessions; synthesized fieldwork into personas and journey maps; flagged a naming rejection before launch.
- Designed a mixed-method evaluation of Amazon's brand mascot with AI-driven eye-tracking, giving the client an evidence-based framework to retain, evolve, or retire it.

Research Associate, Third Eye Integrated Services

August 2023 – April 2024

- Co-moderated a longitudinal Recollective diary study of Indian consumers' AI use for Google; coordinated 13 studies end-to-end, wrote 4 recruitment questionnaires, and adapted screening for 5+ studies.

ADDITIONAL RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Scholar, Northwestern Medill Spiegel Research Center

October 2025 – September 2026

- Selected as 1 of 6 scholars from a cohort of 120; conducted a qualitative study of 12 non-U.S.-born women, using AI-assisted coding to identify mechanisms for converting non-U.S.-born attendees into sports fans.

Data Analyst, WageIndicator Foundation

October 2022 – April 2023

- Built 10+ Tableau visualizations of labor market data across 50+ countries for public dashboards and Annual Reports.

Market Research Intern, Quantum Consumer Solutions: Insight & Design Strategy

June 2022 – September 2022

- Moderated digital diaries and Miro boards to map category and content strategies ahead of YouTube Shorts India launch.

EDUCATION

Northwestern University, Medill School of Journalism – MS, Integrated Marketing Communication

Expected Dec. 2026

- GPA: 3.93. Selected as Grader, IMC 401 Consumer Insight (Fall 2026).

FLAME University – Postgraduate Diploma, Interdisciplinary Studies and Research

2022 – 2023

- GPA: 8.47/10; Academic Merit Scholarship.

FLAME University – BBA, Communications Management (Minor in Economics)

2019 – 2022

- Class Rank: 2/46. GPA: 8.5/10. Silver Medal (2022); Dean's Roll of Honor, all semesters.

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Strategy & Analysis: TAM/SAM/SOM Market Sizing, whitespace and competitive analysis, financial modeling, product/brand positioning, go-to-market recommendations, PESTLE

Research & Synthesis: Mixed-methods research, survey design, depth interviews, focus groups, diary studies, ethnography, phenomenology, emic/etic coding, AI-assisted analysis

Quantitative Methods: k-means audience segmentation, factor analysis, logistic regression, survival analysis, A/B testing, effect sizes

Tools & Platforms: Excel, PowerPoint, R, SPSS, STATA, Tableau, Qualtrics, Recollective, Mintel, MRI Simmons, Simply Analytics

Interests & Languages: Endurance sports, powerlifting (Bronze, Nationals 2023; state/regional golds). English, Hindi, Marathi